

A. LESSON PLAN FOR E CLASS ENGLISH (REF. UNIT 5 - LESSON 2)

Class: E (5th grade)

Level of students: A1 - Breakthrough stage (CEF)

Age: 10-11

Number of students in class: 20-30

Time available: 4 sessions-40 minutes each

Materials to be used: a questionnaire, a listening passage, a text:
adapted from www.panda.org

Class organization: individual, pair and group work

Methods to be used: inductive/task-based learning

Overall theme or topic planned: Let's do it – Lesson 2 of Unit 5 – inviting pupils to take action in order to save planet Earth.

Aims

Teaching aims: to invite pupils to revise the vocabulary on recycling and environmental issues

: to use modals can, must, should to express ability,
obligation and give advice

: to encourage pair and group work

: to invite pupils to prepare a presentation on a specific
topic using resources and following steps

Learning aims: to encourage pupils' speaking skills

: to engage pupils in a problem-solving task

: to activate their background knowledge on the theme

: to sensitize pupils to environmental issues

: to help them develop critical thinking

CROSS-CURRICULAR APPROACH

The topic of environmental issues is presented, discussed and researched. The tasks are based on students' active cooperation aiming at their autonomous learning and at their active participation in and outside the school.

A. Lead-in 8/ Presentation of the topic:

Time: 3 mins

Lesson 2 of Unit 5 comes as a sequence of Lesson 1, as it is based on the same topic: Ready for action to reduce waste, to recycle and to save the planet. Therefore, the pupils have already discussed these issues and have been exposed to the relevant vocabulary. They have also used the Greenpeace website for more information, in order to fulfill the tasks. Pupils are most of the times asked to do things, to organize campaigns, to present their ideas to people and generally to imitate real life situations. Learning by doing i.e. interacting in meaningful activities is what task-based learning is based on.

In Lesson 2 the teacher introduces the pupils to the new issues asking them:

"Do you remember Kostas' class environmental project?" This question serves as a very good reminder of what has already been discussed, of the vocabulary already used and helps the teacher take the pupils to the next step and present the topic which is the pupils' environmental attitude. Questions like

What do you do with your rubbish?

- Do you recycle paper at home or at school?
- Have you ever thought that the protection of the environment is a personal matter? make pupils realise that people's attitude against the environment is of paramount importance. Thus, one of our learning aims, that of sensitizing pupils to environmental problems, is fulfilled.

Pre-reading

The teacher now explains that the pupils are going to answer ten questions related to the main topic and that a questionnaire is common practice for those who make a survey and use the results in order to change things. At that stage pupils can be encouraged to raise their own questions, which also remind them of what they already know and think, i.e. of their existing schematic knowledge. The pupils should realise that they must be sensitive about the issues of energy, pollution, recycling, waste etc.

Whilst-reading

The pupils are asked to read the questionnaire individually. Then, they check to see what kind of citizens they are. As the passage is authentic material, slightly modified for the pupils' level, it encourages the readers' engagement with it and offers a good reason for them to read it. If they ask for unknown words, the teacher tries to make them understand from the context.

DO YOU LOVE OUR PLANET? Let's find out together.
REMEMBER TO BE HONEST!!!!



1. Do you turn off the light when you leave your bedroom?
a. Yes, always b. Sometimes c. No, I don't. Why?
2. How do you usually go to school?
a. By car b. On foot c. By bus
3. What do you usually do with your rubbish from a picnic?
a. I leave it there b. I put it in a rubbish bin c. I take it home
4. Do you use both sides of a piece of paper when you write?
a. Sometimes b. Never c. I usually do
5. Do you ever use recycled paper?
a. What's that? b. Usually c. Sometimes
6. What do you usually do if there is rubbish on the beach?
a. I take it and put it in the litter bin b. I leave it on the beach c. I throw it in the sea
7. Do you buy plastic cups, knives or forks?
a. Yes, I do. I hate washing up b. Sometimes c. No, never
8. Do you watch environmental programmes on TV?
a. No, never b. Very seldom c. Yes, always
9. Do you leave the water running when you brush your teeth?
a. Yes, I do. b. Sometimes. c. No, never.
10. Do you take part in planting expeditions with your school or city?
a. Yes, sometimes. b. No, never. c. Yes, I usually do it twice a year.

(Adapted from Myles, J. (2001) Holidays and Special Days in the USA and www.link2english.com)

Post-reading

The pupils check their answers and compare them with the results of their partners. It is important at that point not only to test the pupils' reading abilities but also to teach them right from wrong behaviour. These questions work as a test which helps pupils see whether their attitude to nature is positive or not. The teacher therefore, discusses the results and praises those

who got a high score, trying to raise pupils' awareness about environmental issues.

C. SPEAKING & WRITING (Ref. METHODOLOGICAL TIPS pp. 10 & 11) Time: 15 mins

This task does not require any use of specific linguistic forms, it is open for pupils to organize and therefore not easy for the teacher to handle. The pupils should be given precise directions. A crucial matter here is time limit, which for young learners forms a difficulty they have to overcome. In order to do this, they develop the appropriate strategies (note taking, diagrams, use of known vocabulary etc.) so as to gain time. Of course they very often use their mother tongue as well, but banning mother-tongue use altogether might not be advisable. Weaker students often tend to stop speaking. Pupils should be made to realise that they use English for communication purposes and that is what they must try to do. Encourage them to experiment with the L2 and use the L1 only to explain something complex that the other pupils might not understand.

Working in pairs or groups here helps the teacher manage classroom interaction so as to offer opportunities for all the pupils to use their limited language and to create a more effective learning environment. In group work there could be one "chairperson" who will lead the discussion and will ensure that each partner gets time to contribute to the conversation. Pair work, on the other hand, provides a more "private" setting for shier pupils to speak.

Pre-speaking

The teacher tells the pupils that they do not have to do the project right now. They only have to prepare two or three activities in order to inform pupils in other schools about the environmental problems in their area. They should think of what problems to talk about, what ways they will use to present them and what actions they are thinking of taking. The questions given in the SB will help the pupils organize their work and develop their critical thinking so as to decide which problems are the most important.

Whilst-speaking

The teacher checks that the pairs or groups are formed and goes around so as to help pupils with the L2 and encourages them to use already known vocabulary. The pupils develop their speaking skills in order to handle a problem-solving task. Time, as mentioned before, is important, so the teacher makes clear that they have only three days to prepare the project. This makes pupils concentrate and collaborate so as to present an outcome in time.

Post-speaking

It is now time for pupils to present their work in class. They must explain what the targets of their campaign are and what they expect to achieve. Pupils may put the targets and their expectations on the board. This way, they make peer discussion easier. The teacher can promote the conversation with questions like:

- What is the aim of your campaign?
- What do you expect to achieve?
- Do you think that people will change their habits?
- What means are you going to use to make your problems known?
- For an alternative speaking task with a crosscurricular approach teachers may use the ideas, the Internet sites and the relevant books and periodicals suggested on page 135 of the Appendix. It would be advisable to introduce pupils to the suggested material, although more time might be needed. The teacher should give precise directions on how to use the Internet, books and other school resources and set clearly that the pupils are expected to cooperate and make some small scale research. Cooperation between teachers of different subjects stimulates pupils and teachers alike. The pupils work in

groups and get ready to present the outcome of their research.

D. LISTENING (Ref. METHODOLOGICAL TIPS p. 10)

Time: 15 mins

Pre-listening

- The teacher reads the instructions and explains what a summit meeting for the environment is:
- Important people from different countries around the world meet and discuss ways of protecting the environment. The participating countries decide whether or not they will sign and respect the agreement.
- The teacher asks the pupils to guess what the passage is going to be about.
- The teacher is also given a chance to review once more the relevant vocabulary together with the words of the items pictured on page 67.



Words like
plastic bag
cloth bag
cardboard box
recyclable
ecological packaging

to recycle
to protest
to reuse
recycle symbol

should be mentioned and pre-taught through the pictures.

Whilst-listening

The aim of this activity is listening for specific information. The teacher plays the tape/CD – more than once if needed - and the pupils work individually and put a tick next to items mentioned and a cross next to items not mentioned in the tape.

TAPESCRIPT

Activist: ...but of course we can make a real difference! Even children like you can take action! For example, when you go shopping with your parents look for products that have less packaging or use ecological packaging. You can check the packaging by reading the symbols. Even better, you can also buy fresh, non-packaged produce. You can also ask your mum to bring a cloth bag or reuse an old plastic bag to carry home your groceries and other shopping. Why not ask for cardboard boxes at the supermarket? They can be reused for other purposes or recycled.

And one more thing...when you shop, you should always look for products that can be recycled – or have been recycled already. Look for the recycle symbol on the label.

Kostas: Do you really believe that we can make older people listen to us? But.....(fading out)

Post-listening

In pairs the pupils check their choices.

In groups of 3 or 4 they form the main idea each picture represents and offer more suggestions. One pupil from each group reports to the class.

Possible outcome:

(picture b) *Plastic bags destroy the environment. We must use paper bags.*

(picture d) *Buy products with the recycle sign. We protect the Earth.*

GRAMMAR FOCUS (Ref. METHODOLOGICAL TIPS p. 12)

Time: 10 mins

In the grammar focus section the teacher is asked to use the PPP model of instruction.

Presentation of grammar structures and functions

The teacher asks the pupils to look at the structures in the section and reminds them of any modals they had met in D' class. The pupils are then asked, according to the inductive model of learning, to elicit the rules for the use of the specific modals. They are helped by the teacher with questions like:

- How are the modals formed? (modal + infinitive)
- How are they different from ordinary verbs? (they do not form all tenses)
- What function each one has? (used to express ability, obligation, advice)

Practice

The teacher encourages the pupils to elicit responses using the above structures. The questionnaire on page 65 may prove very useful. Possible outcome:

- What must people do with their rubbish?
- We should use recycled paper in order to protect the trees.
- Students should watch environmental programmes on TV.
- We can take part in a protest against air pollution.

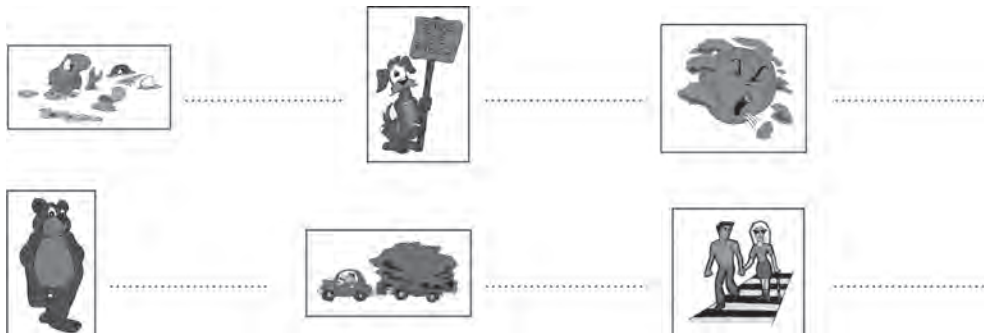
Production

The teacher writes the pupils' responses on the board to use them later in their projects, in the appropriate context.

E. PAIR OR GROUP WORK (Ref. METHODOLOGICAL TIPS p. 11)

Time: 15 mins

- The teacher explains to the pupils that they do not have to finish the whole task together with the creation of the poster on the same day. What they have to do first is to discuss on what to include working in pairs or in groups of 4. This task (very similar to C. Speaking) presupposes precise guidelines from the teacher. The teacher could also show the pupils other posters which might hang up on the walls and explain how to make it attractive and presentable. The most competent pupils, those who are good at drawing or at team coordinating might be the "leaders" of a group. The pupils have to decide on the ideas they are going to include and the tasks each pupils is going to take up. The pictures on page 68 give some ideas for possible titles:



Water pollution
Air pollution
Road safety instruction

Animals in Danger
Rubbish
Save the Forests

- The teacher sets a time limit for the preparation of the poster and moves around offering any help needed. The use of the recently taught modals would be appropriate and the teacher should remind the pupils of that. Arrangements should be made for one more session so as to draw, cut, glue and do any handwriting to finish the poster.

F. READING & WRITING (Ref. METHODOLOGICAL TIPS pp. 9 & 10) Time: 20 mins

The task consists of two parts and it forms an integrated suggestion of the crosscurricular approach to learning. It sensitizes students in every day multicultural issues, the pupils work cooperatively on authentic material (adapted from the Net), the outcome is as important as the action they take.

Pre-reading

- The pupils are invited to read only the title of the passage, look at the picture and guess what the topic is going to be. They are, therefore, introduced to the idea that all the people of the Mediterranean share the same environmental problems. If the pupils are not very sure of which the countries of the Mediterranean are, the teacher uses a map to show them the Mediterranean sea and the countries around it. Before going on reading the passage it would be a good idea to revise the vocabulary related to countries, nationalities, geography, weather etc. Also the teacher encourages pupils to speak and discuss any environmental problems of the Mediterranean countries, i.e. let them talk about air pollution, climate changes, forest destruction etc.

Whilst-reading

- The pupils read the passage and in pairs or groups they try to guess the meaning of the

Mediterranean Forests

The Mediterranean is one of the most important regions in the world for its forests. These forests are situated in an area between the European, African and Asian continents and are very important for their biodiversity features – plants and animals.

But the Mediterranean forests are under threat. One of the most serious threats is fires. This has caused serious problems in the area during the last few decades. Other general threats to Mediterranean forests are:

- Climate change
- Droughts and floodings
- Extensive building development
- Atmospheric pollution



unknown words.

- The words given – most of them unknown – are very important and useful in order to describe the problem. The pictures which follow add some more clues to the main issue.



Italy

People cause fires



Lebanon

Violence and war destroys the natural environment



Greece

Building development threatens forests



Turkey

Too much lumbering reduces forests

Post-reading and Writing

- At that level the post-reading stage coincides with the writing stage. The pupils have read the passage and the picture captions and they are asked to make a list of possible solutions to these problems. They work in pairs and, using the L2 and the relevant vocabulary, try to come to solutions concerning the environmental problems the Mediterranean countries face. They develop their critical thinking, they practise speaking skills and vocabulary and at the same time they raise their awareness of the serious environmental problems.
- The teacher encourages the pupils to make a list of the problems and the suggested solutions. Then, the findings are presented in class and are compared with other pupils' suggestions.

The crosscurricular approach

Several projects can be conducted based on group work:

1. The pupils could use the relevant site [www.panda.org] and the school library to read more on the topic and collect information. Then, they could make posters to hang on the walls and leaflets to hand out to their fellow students.
2. The teacher of English could collaborate with the teachers of Chemistry, Biology and Geography so as to offer a model lesson based on the cross-curricular approach to teaching. Photographs, maps and designs could be used to explain how pollution works, what the acid rain is and how the sea and the fish are polluted and destroyed.
3. Exchange visits could be organized between Mediterranean schools from countries which belong to the European Union through a European Mobility Programme.

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